China Auto Supply Chain

September: cost pressure re-emerging; Q326 preview favours Kedali

Equities

China

Auto Parts

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Revenue growth: modest improvement supported by seasonality

In September, China's passenger vehicle wholesale volume fell 9% YoY but rose 8% MoM. NEV wholesale volume increased 11% YoY and 10% MoM, lifting wholesale NEV penetration by 12ppt YoY to 65%. China's battery production (including EV and ESS batteries) extended strong YoY growth to September. Overseas, US light vehicle sales were up 4% YoY but down 5% MoM (down 1% and 2% YoY/MoM, selling day adjusted). Combined light vehicle sales in Europe's five largest markets (the UK, Germany, France, Spain and Italy) were up 11% YoY, while EV sales rose 55% YoY. According to our revenue projection model, seasonal tailwinds supported revenue growth across China's auto supply chain in September, although the overall momentum remained muted amid continued weakness in domestic auto demand. We believe Kedali will continue to lead monthly revenue growth driven by robust battery demand growth YoY, while Yinlun should also maintained solid growth supported by overseas expansion and ramp-up of its AIDC power generation business. For more details, see our China auto parts monthly database.

Cost pressure: broad based inflation

In September, prices for most key raw materials continued to rise, indicating broadening cost pressure. Among key raw materials, carbon black (up 62.2% YoY), plastic (up 45.4%), copper (up 38.8%), nylon (up 33.5%), and synthetic rubber (up 30.7%) recorded the most notable YoY increases. One notable exception was soda ash, the price of which declined 0.7% MoM and 8.0% YoY, with the YTD average down 13.0% YoY, which we believe should benefit Fuyao. Steel and iron ore prices also remained relatively benign. For smart vehicle component suppliers, we expect elevated memory prices to remain a drag on margins. Exporters may also face incremental cost pressure, given the respective 68% and 184% YoY increases in the China Containerized Freight Index and the Shanghai Containerized Freight Index.

3Q26 preview: we prefer Kedali, Fuyao, Yinlun, and Sanhua

Our 3Q26 preview highlights selective opportunities despite a subdued auto market. We see Kedali, Yinlun and Sanhua as well positioned to deliver stronger-than-expected revenue growth in 3Q26. We forecast YoY revenue growth of c.45% for Kedali and 20-25% for Yinlun, while Sanhua's growth should return to above 10%. Fuyao could deliver low single-digit YoY revenue growth, underscoring greater resilience than current market expectations. Across the auto supply chain, we believe raw material costs remained elevated YoY in 3Q26, although inflationary pressure eased modestly QoQ. Fuyao is a notable exception, supported by structural cost tailwinds: soda ash prices declined both YoY and QoQ, while PVB prices fixed at end-2025 reduced exposure to oil-price volatility, we therefore expect further gross margin expansion in 3Q26. At the operating profit level, we forecast YoY growth of c.40% for Kedali and c.20% for Yinlun, among the strongest within our coverage, while Fuyao should deliver high single-digit growth.

Sector and stock implications

Kedali is our top pick, given its attractive valuation after recent correction and its successful order accumulation in the humanoid business. We also favour **Fuyao** for its strong potential to gain global market share and raise ASPs, as well as **Yinlun** and **Sanhua** for the resilience of their automotive thermal-management business and upside prospects from expansion into AIDC infrastructure business.

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Figure 1: China auto parts companies' revenue growth and margin pressure (September 2026)

Revenue growth and GPM pressure

Company name	Revenue forecasts						Sep GPM pressure YoY	Sep GPM pressure MoM
	Sep YoY	Sep MoM	Sep rev. contribution from Aito	Sep rev. contribution from Li Auto	Sep rev. contribution from Tesla	Sep rev. contribution from Xiaomi		
Fuyao								
Sanhua								
Shuanghuan								
Desay SV								
Xingyu								
Keboda								
Joyson								
Linglong	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A		
Foryou								
Huayu								
Nexteer								
Minth								
Kedali			N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A		
Rongtai			N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A		
Yinlun			N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A		

Source: Company data, China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), UBS-S estimates.

Figure 2: Price changes of key COGS items

Price change of key COGS items

Raw material (Rmb/t)	Sep average	Aug average	Year begin	Sep YoY	Sep MoM	YTD Avg YoY
Soda ash	1,150	1,158	1,245	-8.0%	-0.7%	-13.0%
Plastic	9,917	9,329	6,320	45.4%	6.3%	22.1%
Aluminum	24,365	23,898	21,806	19.4%	2.0%	17.2%
Copper	110,501	108,134	95,461	38.8%	2.2%	32.9%
Steel	3,843	3,817	3,884	-3.2%	0.7%	-4.1%
Iron ore (62%Fe,CFR)	97	96	106	-8.3%	0.6%	0.2%
Natural rubber	18,439	17,210	15,300	24.5%	7.1%	12.9%
Synthetic rubber	15,250	13,781	11,400	30.7%	10.7%	15.2%
Carbon black	10,135	7,505	5,750	62.2%	35.0%	16.0%
Nylon	15,637	14,056	11,400	33.5%	11.2%	9.6%
Brent Crude Oil (US$/bbl)	117.1	91.1	61.3	71.7%	28.5%	35.5%
NYMEX natural gas (US$/MMbtu)	3.0	2.8	3.6	-2.0%	6.8%	-11.0%
China containerized freight index	1,888	1,836	1,195	58.5%	2.8%	21.2%
Shanghai containerized freight index	3,658	3,388	1,647	183.8%	8.0%	55.1%

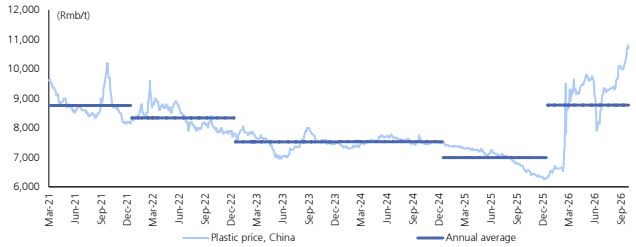
Source: Wind, Baiinfo

Figure 3: Soda ash prices in China



Source: Wind

Figure 4: Plastic prices in China



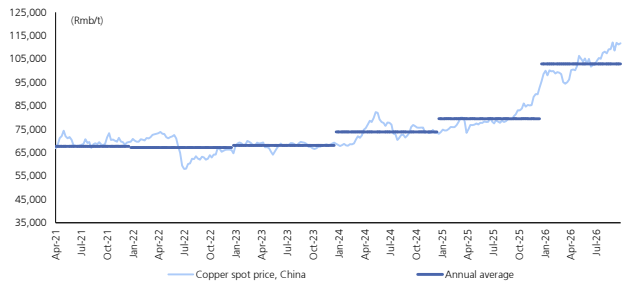
Source: Wind. Note: We use PP (polypropylene, a thermoplastic polymer used in a wide variety of applications) as a reference for plastic prices.

Figure 5: Aluminium spot prices in China



Source: Wind

Figure 6: Copper spot prices in China



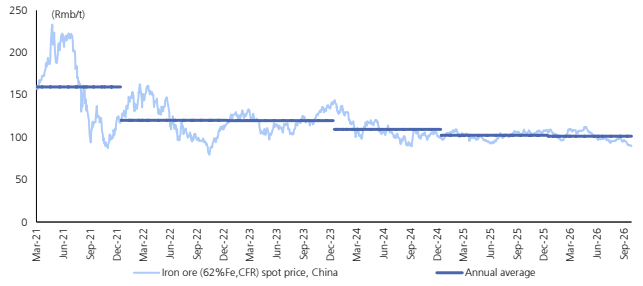
Source: Wind

Figure 7: Steel spot prices in China



Source: Wind

Figure 8: Iron ore (62% Fe, CFR) spot prices in China



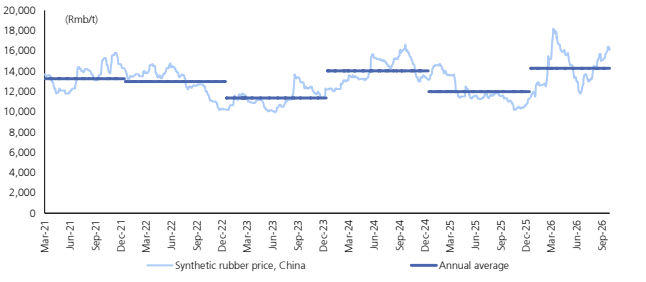
Source: Wind

Figure 9: Natural rubber prices in China



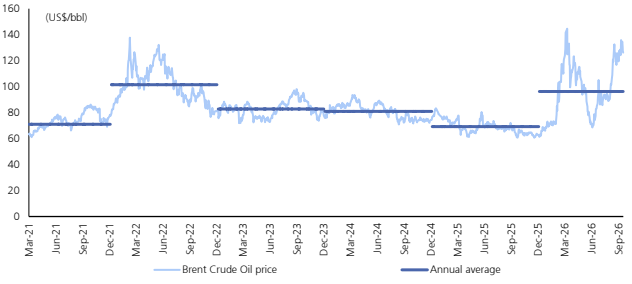
Source: Wind

Figure 10: Synthetic rubber prices in China



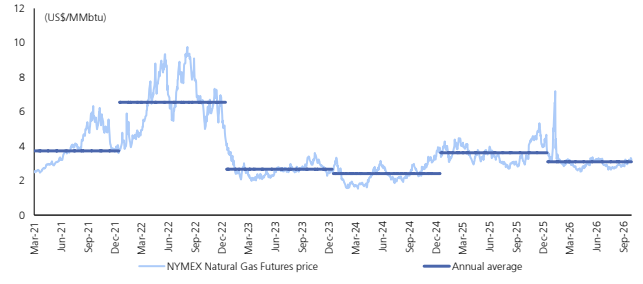
Source: Wind

Figure 11: Brent crude oil price



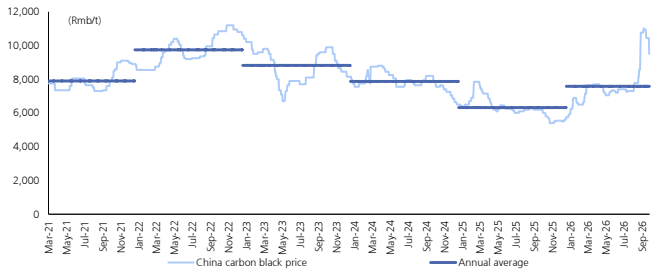
Source: Wind

Figure 12: NYMEX natural gas futures price



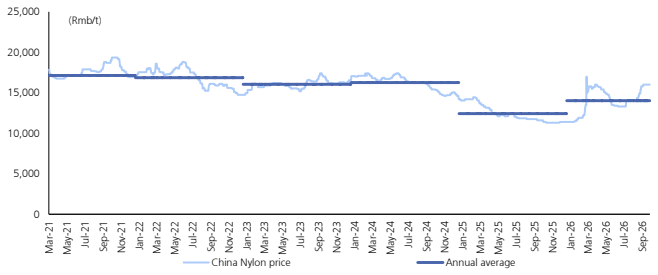
Source: Wind

Figure 13: Carbon black prices in China



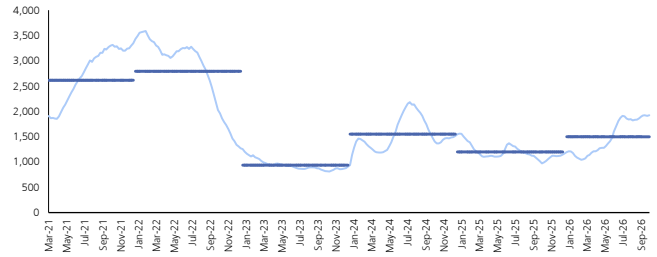
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 14: Nylon prices in China



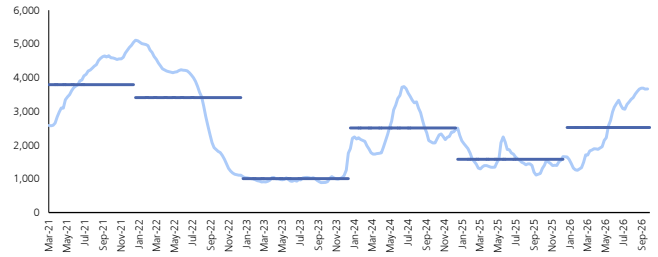
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 15: CCFI



Source: Wind

Figure 16: SCFI



Source: Wind

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We think risks to China's auto parts sector include: 1) demand for auto parts being dampened by lower auto production; 2) automakers, with earnings squeezed by slowing car sales, passing price pressure onto parts suppliers; 3) price pressure brought by intensified competition; 4) higher auto part costs due to raw material cost inflation; 5) worse-than-expected sector consolidation; and 6) product recalls triggered by product quality issues.

Kedali: Our price target is based on DCF.
We think the main company-specific risks facing Kedali are: 1) slower-than-expected capacity building and launch; 2) slower-than-expected capacity building at major customers; 3) significant loss of share at major customers; and 4) product quality issues. We think the main industry risks facing Kedali are: 1) a weaker-than-expected rise in EV penetration; 2) significant price pressure placed by battery firms on upstream structural parts businesses; 3) capacity launch by, and market share losses to, competitors; and 4) rising prices of main raw materials including copper and aluminum. We think the main macro and regional risks facing Kedali are: 1) declining passenger vehicle sales volume amid a macro downturn; and 2) adverse impact of trade friction on parts imports and exports.

Fuyao: Our price target is based on a DCF methodology.
We believe major downside risks the company could face include: 1) slower-than-expected increases in sales of its high-value products; 2) clients cancelling or postponing orders; and 3) product recalls due to quality issues.
We believe major sector risks the company could face include: 1) declining auto parts demand caused by slower passenger vehicle industry growth; 2) overseas competitors ramping up capacity in China, leading to price competition; 3) higher costs of labour or raw materials; and 4) worse-than-expected adoption of all-glass roofs and HUDs.
We believe major macro and regional risks the company could face include: 1) passenger vehicle industry contraction caused by macroeconomic slowdown; and 2) further trade conflict escalation, affecting import/export tariffs on auto parts.

Yinlun: We use DCF methodology to value Zhejiang Yinlun Machinery.
Company-specific risks include: 1) disappointing progress in product line expansion and implementation of the platform-based supply strategy; 2) delay in fulfilment or push-out of digital & energy orders; 3) slower-than-expected digital & energy client base expansion.
Industry risks include: 1) weaker-than-expected auto demand; 2) slower-than-expected PV electrification overseas; 3) intense competition in the PV market, squeezing earnings upside of auto parts suppliers; 4) undershooting IDC and ESS capex triggering uncertainty in the fulfilment of digital & energy orders; 5) cost inflation due to raw material price hikes.

Sanhua: Our price target is based on a DCF methodology.
Upside risks include: 1) better-than-expected output growth in the air-conditioner and passenger vehicle industries; 2) better-than-expected Tesla Model 3/Y sales; 3) higher-than-expected gross margin of thermal management components; and 4) liquid cooling and robotics businesses beat expectations.
Downside risks include: 1) slower-than-expected fulfilment of orders on hand; 2) a sharp rise in the prices of raw materials, such as copper and aluminium; and 3) heavier-than-expected price pressure passed on from downstream auto OEMs.

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage[1]	IB Services[2]
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	39%	20%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 September 2026.
1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.
2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

KEY DEFINITIONS:Forecast Stock Return (FSR) is expected percentage price appreciation plus gross dividend yield over the next 12 months. In some cases, this yield may be based on accrued dividends. **Market Return Assumption (MRA)** is the one-year local market interest rate plus 5% (a proxy for, and not a forecast of, the equity risk premium). **Under Review (UR)** Stocks may be flagged by the analyst to indicate that the stock's price target and/or rating may change in the near term, usually in response to an event that may affect the investment case or valuation. **Equity Price Targets** have a 12-month investment horizon.

EXCEPTIONS AND SPECIAL CASES:UK and European Investment Fund ratings and definitions are: Buy: Positive on factors such as structure, management, performance record and discount; **Neutral:** Neutral on factors such as structure, management, performance record and discount; **Sell:** Negative on factors such as structure, management, performance record and discount. **Core Banding Exceptions (CBE):** Exceptions to the standard +/-6% bands may be granted by the Investment Review Consultation (IRC). Factors considered by the IRC include the stock's volatility and the credit spread of the respective company's debt. As a result, stocks deemed very high or low risk may be subject to higher or lower bands for rating purposes. Where such exceptions apply, they will be identified in the Company Disclosures table in the relevant research piece.

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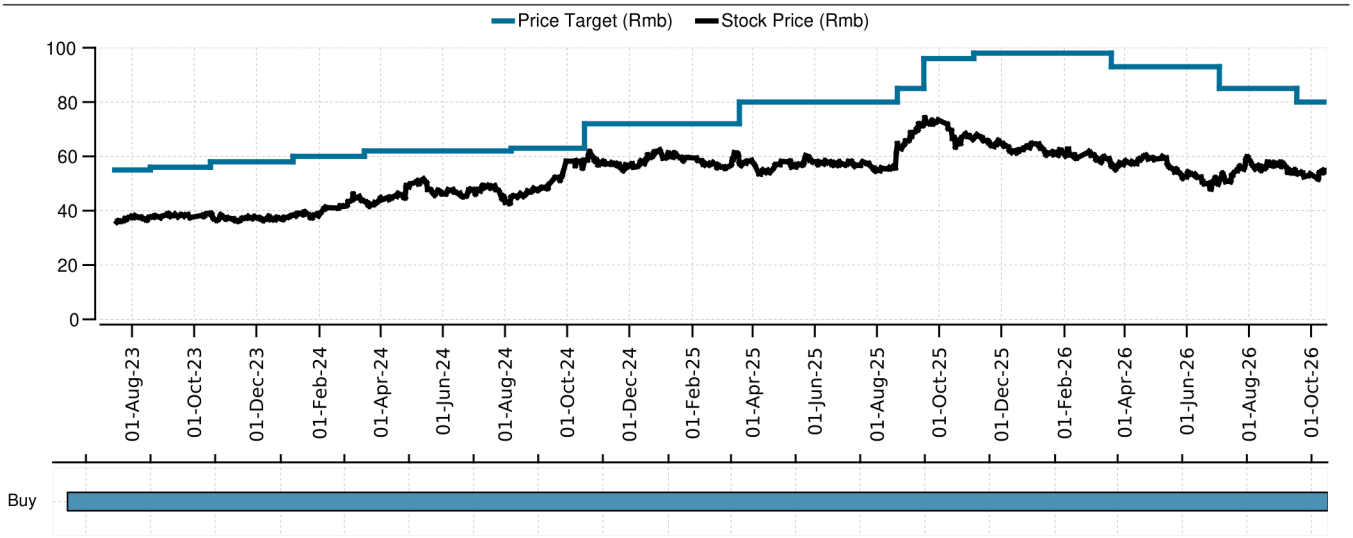
Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Fuyao Glass[28,18]	3606.HK	Buy	HK$55.60	16 Oct 2026
Fuyao Glass - A[28,18]	600660.SS	Buy	Rmb54.78	16 Oct 2026
Shenzhen Kedali Industry	002850.SZ	Buy	Rmb139.68	16 Oct 2026
Zhejiang Sanhua Intelligent Controls	002050.SZ	Buy	Rmb31.42	16 Oct 2026
Zhejiang Yinlun Machinery	002126.SZ	Buy	Rmb29.71	16 Oct 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.
18. Market capitalisation is calculated by multiplying the current share price by the sum of A and H shares.
28. UBS holds a long position of 0.5% or more of the listed shares of this company.

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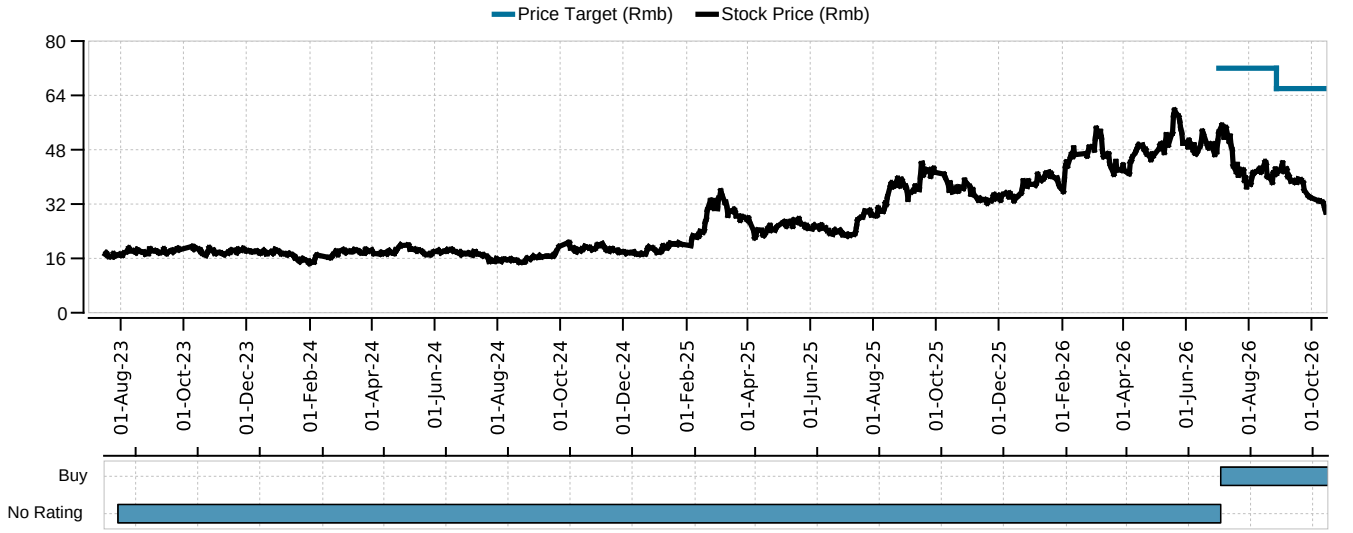
Fuyao Glass - A (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-07-14	36.20	55.00	Buy
2023-08-18	37.63	56.00	Buy
2023-10-16	38.95	58.00	Buy
2024-01-05	38.31	60.00	Buy
2024-03-15	43.65	62.00	Buy
2024-08-06	42.87	63.00	Buy
2024-10-17	56.86	72.00	Buy
2025-03-18	60.45	80.00	Buy
2025-08-20	61.35	85.00	Buy
2025-09-15	71.35	96.00	Buy
2025-11-03	66.26	98.00	Buy
2026-03-18	57.75	93.00	Buy
2026-07-02	49.81	85.00	Buy
2026-09-16	54.21	80.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 16-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

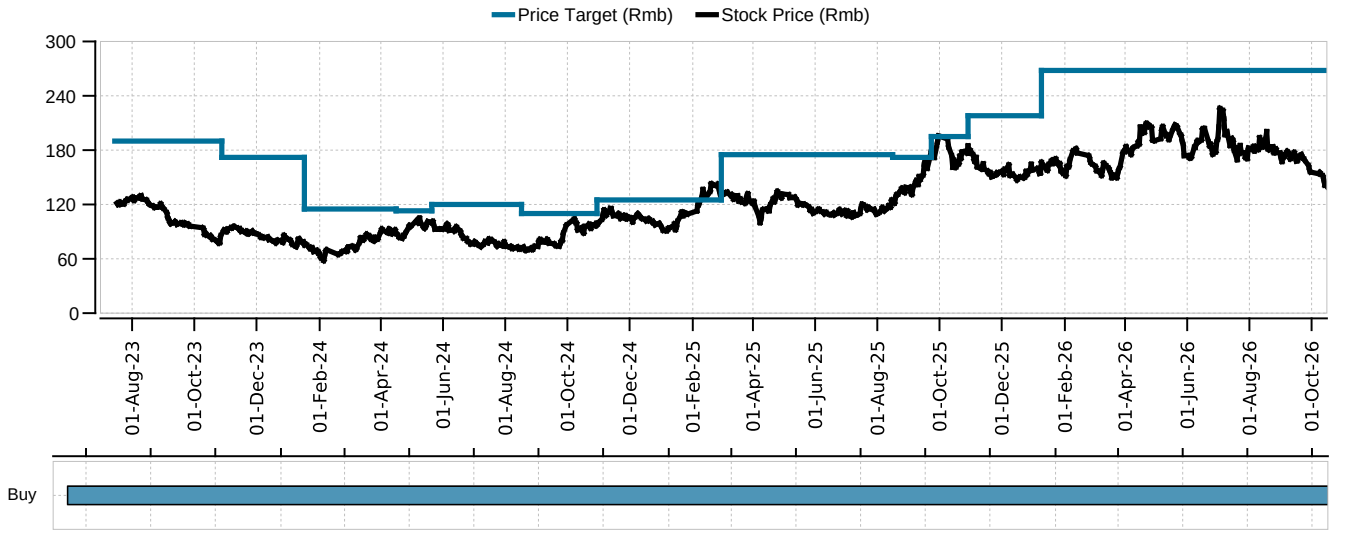
Zhejiang Yinlun Machinery (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-07-14	17.34	-	No Rating
2026-07-02	50.48	72.00	Buy
2026-08-27	42.30	66.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 16-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

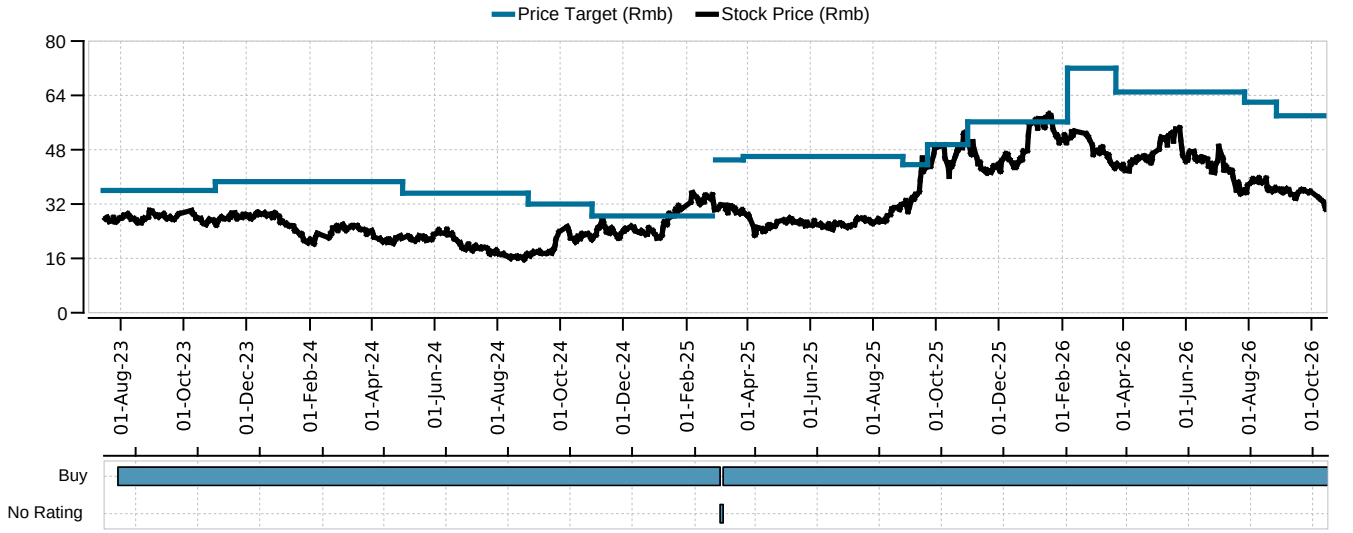
Shenzhen Kedali Industry (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-07-14	127.79	190.00	Buy
2023-10-27	85.59	172.00	Buy
2024-01-16	78.74	115.00	Buy
2024-04-15	92.00	113.00	Buy
2024-05-20	99.75	120.00	Buy
2024-08-16	71.05	110.00	Buy
2024-10-29	98.99	125.00	Buy
2025-02-28	130.88	175.00	Buy
2025-08-15	124.77	172.00	Buy
2025-09-22	173.78	195.00	Buy
2025-10-28	176.86	218.00	Buy
2026-01-08	154.70	268.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 16-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

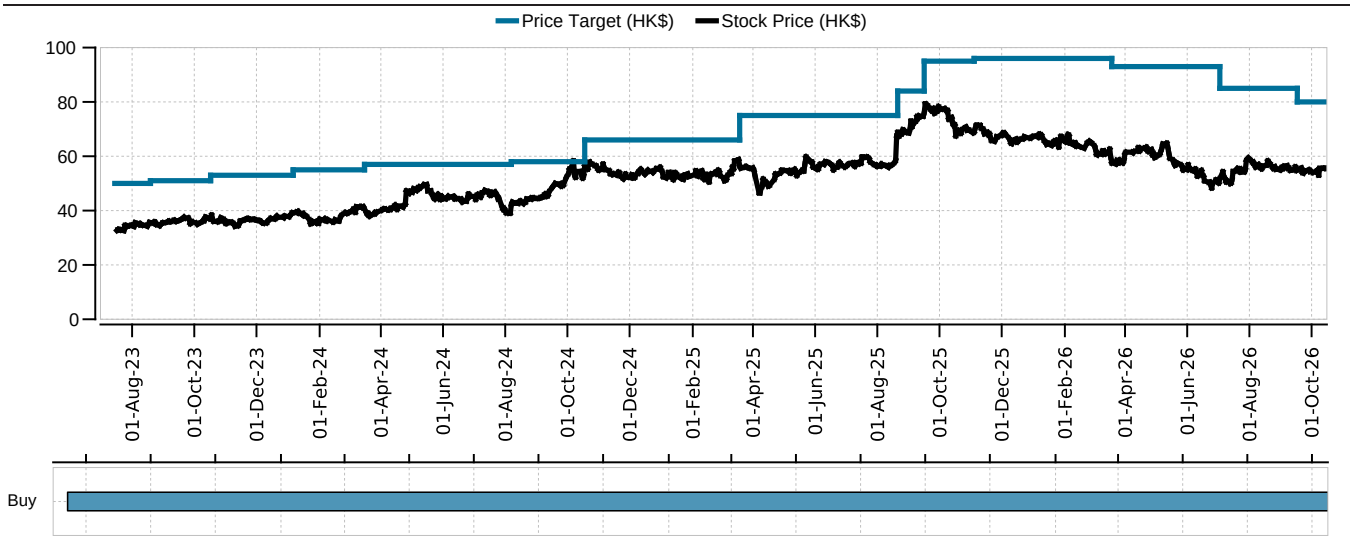
Zhejiang Sanhua Intelligent Controls (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-07-14	27.91	36.00	Buy
2023-10-31	26.74	38.60	Buy
2024-04-30	21.91	35.20	Buy
2024-08-30	17.34	32.00	Buy
2024-10-31	21.88	28.50	Buy
2025-02-25	34.00	-	No Rating
2025-02-28	30.32	45.00	Buy
2025-03-27	30.29	46.00	Buy
2025-08-29	31.88	43.60	Buy
2025-09-22	42.97	49.50	Buy
2025-10-31	49.93	56.20	Buy
2026-02-05	50.09	72.00	Buy
2026-03-24	42.57	65.00	Buy
2026-07-27	36.03	62.00	Buy
2026-08-27	36.82	58.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 16-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Fuyao Glass (HK$)



Date	Stock Price (HK$)	Price Target (HK$)	Rating
2023-07-14	32.65	50.00	Buy

Date	Stock Price (HK$)	Price Target (HK$)	Rating
2023-08-18	35.65	51.00	Buy
2023-10-16	37.00	53.00	Buy
2024-01-05	39.20	55.00	Buy
2024-03-15	41.40	57.00	Buy
2024-08-06	39.10	58.00	Buy
2024-10-17	52.90	66.00	Buy
2025-03-18	58.80	75.00	Buy
2025-08-20	67.50	84.00	Buy
2025-09-15	74.70	95.00	Buy
2025-11-03	68.65	96.00	Buy
2026-03-18	59.65	93.00	Buy
2026-07-02	50.15	85.00	Buy
2026-09-16	54.80	80.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 16-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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